

Claude Certified Associate Foundations Cheat Sheet

PROMPTING AND TASK EXECUTION

14% OF EXAM

Prompt Anatomy

Task Execution

Task Setup Picker

Prompt vs Context

OUTPUT EVALUATION AND VALIDATION

21% OF EXAM

Output Checks

Evidence Review

Validation Response Picker

Draft vs Final

PRODUCT AND MODEL SELECTION

12% OF EXAM

Product Entry Points

Selection Trade-offs

Chat vs Project

Chat vs Artifact

WORKFLOW INTEGRATION AND SOLUTION DESIGN

16% OF EXAM

Workflow Design

Handoffs and Reuse

Workflow Placement Picker

Human Review Loop

CONFIGURATION AND KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT

12% OF EXAM

Projects and Knowledge

Artifacts and Sharing

Instructions vs Prompt

Knowledge Placement Picker

GOVERNANCE RISK AND RESPONSIBLE USE

15% OF EXAM

Data Governance

Responsible Review

Sensitive vs Approved

Responsibility Gate

TROUBLESHOOTING AND OPTIMIZATION

10% OF EXAM

Troubleshooting

Optimization Signals

Troubleshooting Picker

Prompt vs Context

QUICK FACTS

EXAM CCAO-F	ACCESS Partner organizations only
EMAIL Recognized partner-company email	QUESTIONS 60
FORMAT Multiple choice + multiple response	TIME 120 minutes
PASS 720 scaled	DELIVERY Online or test center
VALIDITY 12 months	RETAKES 14 / 30 / 90 days
ATTEMPT CAP 4 per rolling 12 months	

PROMPT FRAME

PR

Goal, audience, context, constraints, format, check		
Goal: outcome	Audience: reader	Context: evidence
Format: shape		

TASK SETUP PICKER

PR

Output feels generic	→	Add specifics (Goal + audience)
Format keeps drifting	→	Add template (Show example)
Task has stages	→	Decompose (Sequence steps)
Requirements get missed	→	Add checklist (Verify before finish)
Audience mismatch	→	Name reader (Set tone)
Quality remains weak	→	Diagnose first (Change one variable)

PROMPT ANATOMY

PR

Goal Define desired outcome	Audience Name intended reader
Context Supply relevant background	Constraints Set boundaries
Format Specify output shape	Success criteria Define acceptable result

TASK EXECUTION

PR

Role Frame useful expertise	Example Demonstrate expected pattern
Template Stabilize repeated outputs	Decompose Split complex work
Iterate Refine diagnosed weakness	Checklist Verify required elements

VERIFY

VA

Source, coverage, logic, limits, review		
Source: trace	Coverage: complete	Logic: consistent
Review: human		

GROUNDING VS UNSUPPORTED

VA

Grounded Traceable source Claim matches evidence Limits stated	Unsupported No source trail Invented certainty Needs verification
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Evidence before confidence

VALIDATION RESPONSE PICKER

VA

Unsupported number	→	Find primary source (Do not publish)
Citation seems wrong	→	Open source (Check exact claim)
Summary omits sections	→	Compare coverage (Restore material points)
Sources disagree	→	Resolve authority (Prefer governing source)
Inference is necessary	→	Label inference (State assumptions)
High-stakes output	→	Qualified review (Human owns decision)

OUTPUT CHECKS

VA

Accuracy Claims match evidence	Completeness Material points included
Relevance Answers actual task	Consistency No internal conflicts
Usefulness Supports intended decision	Tone Fits audience needs

DRAFT VS FINAL

VA

Draft Working output Errors possible Review required	Final Findings resolved Owner approved Ready for use
<i>Generated is not approved</i>	

EVIDENCE REVIEW

VA

Number Verify primary source	Citation Open and confirm
Quote Check exact wording	Summary Check omitted sections
Inference Label reasoning step	Uncertainty State evidence limits

CHAT VS PROJECT

SE

Chat Standalone conversation Local prompt context Quick task	Project Recurring workstream Durable instructions Shared knowledge files
<i>One task vs sustained work</i>	

PRODUCT ENTRY POINTS

SE

Chat Quick standalone task	Project Recurring body of work
Artifact Standalone editable output	Knowledge files Durable project sources
Project instructions Durable project guidance	New chat Fresh conversation context

CHAT VS ARTIFACT

SE

Chat response Conversational answer Inline explanation Fast iteration	Artifact Standalone output Focused editing Previewable deliverable
<i>Conversation vs work product</i>	

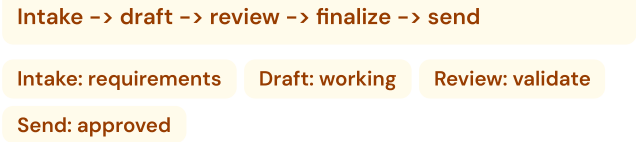
SELECTION TRADE-OFFS

SE

Complexity Required reasoning depth	Latency Response speed need
Cost Budget constraint	Risk Review intensity
Availability Current candidate options	Recheck Capabilities change

HUMAN REVIEW LOOP

WO



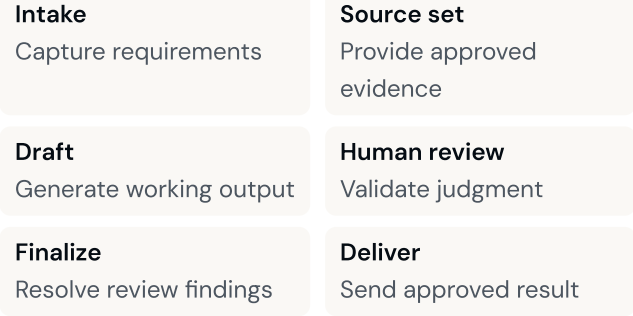
WORKFLOW PLACEMENT PICKER

WO



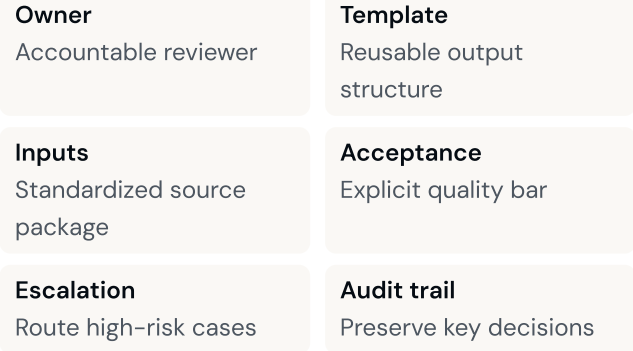
WORKFLOW DESIGN

WO



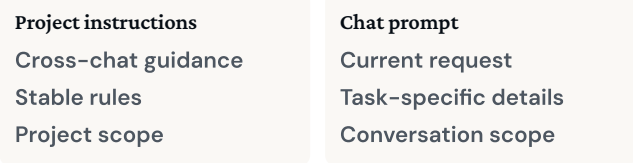
HANDOFFS AND REUSE

WO



INSTRUCTIONS VS PROMPT

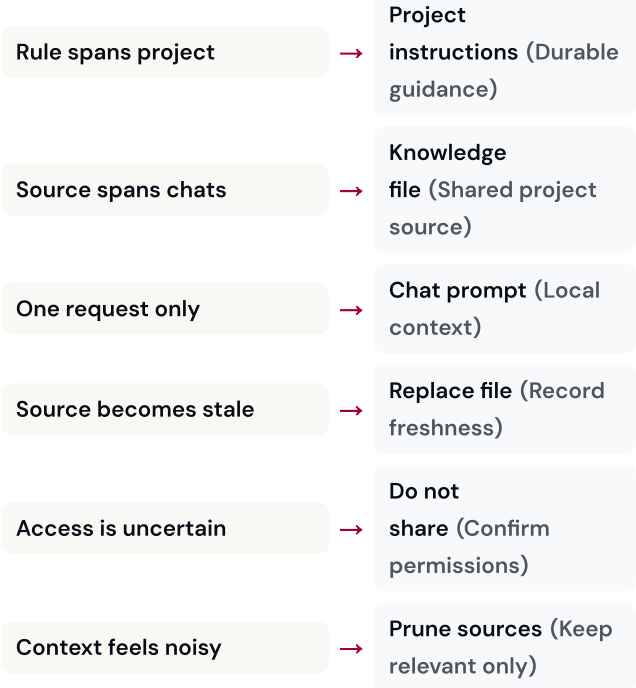
CO



Durable vs local

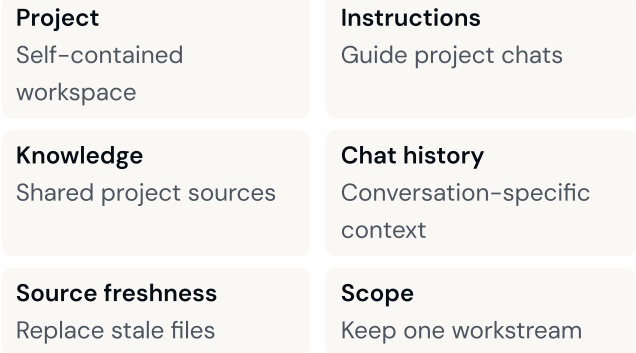
KNOWLEDGE PLACEMENT PICKER

CO



PROJECTS AND KNOWLEDGE

CO



ARTIFACTS AND SHARING

CO

Artifact Standalone work product	Preview Inspect rendered output
Iterate Edit targeted sections	Share Confirm authorization first
Permissions Limit intended access	Secrets Never publish

DATA GOVERNANCE

GO

Sensitive data Require approved handling	Secrets Exclude credentials
Confidentiality Honor access rules	IP Respect usage rights
Retention Follow organization policy	Transparency Disclose when required

TROUBLESHOOTING

TR

Generic output Add task specifics	Missing section Add explicit checklist
Source conflict Resolve authority	Context overload Prune irrelevant material
Inconsistency Standardize instructions	Stale answer Refresh source files

RESPONSIBILITY GATE

GO

Classify, authorize, minimize, review, disclose		
Classify data	Authorize purpose	Minimize input
Disclose when required		

RESPONSIBLE REVIEW

GO

Bias Check unequal impacts	High stakes Require qualified review
Accountability Human owns outcome	Policy Controls permitted use
Consent Respect authorized purpose	Escalate Stop unsafe workflow

OPTIMIZATION SIGNALS

TR

Repeated correction Make rule durable	Prompt drift Reuse template
Weak grounding Constrain source set	Long context Remove low-value content
Format drift Provide output schema	Quality regression Change one variable

SENSITIVE VS APPROVED

GO

Sensitive input Policy check Minimum necessary Controls required	Approved input Authorized purpose Allowed tooling Known access
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Classification before entry

PROMPT VS CONTEXT

TR

Prompt problem Missing instruction Vague success criteria Fix wording	Context problem Wrong sources Too much noise Fix evidence
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Diagnose before changing

COMMON TRAPS

Partner access

Recognized partner-company email ≠ Personal email rejected

Associate tier credit

Credential remains valid ≠ No tier eligibility credit

Scaled vs raw

720 scaled score ≠ Not raw 72%

Project chat context

Knowledge can persist ≠ Chats remain distinct

Generated vs verified

Fluent can be wrong ≠ Evidence decides

More context

Relevant context helps ≠ Noise can degrade

Static model routing

Capabilities change ≠ Recheck current options

LAST MINUTE

1. Partner organization required
2. Recognized partner-company email required
3. 60 questions; MC + MR
4. 120 minutes; English only
5. 720 scaled; not raw 72%
6. Retakes: 14 / 30 / 90 days
7. Maximum four rolling-year attempts
8. Highest domain: Validation 21%
9. Ground claims in sources
10. Human review before external use
11. Projects hold durable knowledge
12. Chats keep distinct context
13. Never paste unauthorized secrets
14. Choose current options by trade-offs



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